

Sri Lanka, Bentota, Lunuganga

What heightens my desire to visit Bentota, with its golden beaches and beguiling scenery, is the fact that master architect Geoffrey Bawa's private bedroom suite in Lunuganga, his iconic country home, is finally open for guests to stay in. The suite, located in the main house, includes his iconic bedroom (furnished with his personal library and a rare selection of original artwork) private courtyard, sitting area and plunge pool. Amid 15-acres of tropical gardens, with scenic views of the Dedduwa lake, are distinctly designed rooms and suites, each with their unique personality.

Daily guided walks get into the nitty-gritty of how Bawa spent close to forty years metamorphising what was once an abandoned rubber estate, into what today is an ode to tropical modernism. I marvel at the way that modernist architectural design is integrated here with tropical vernacular traditions. A short drive away, and infinitely worth seeking out is Brief Garden. This place, a riot of greenery and eccentric character, was designed by landscape architect, enthusiastic artist and collector, Bevis Bawa, Geoffrey's brother. Both garden and home, have been preserved with much of the bohemian spirit of its owner-creator.





Geoffrey Bawa's iconic country home, Lunuganga; Inside "Brief" the home of Bevis Bawa; Abundant gardens and scenic views of the Dedduwa lake add to the experience in Lunuganga